Part 8 Brief · Salon example, then mcp-ops-kit

mcp-ops-server · 20 Oct 2026 · PR #18 · Status: CI green (push + PR runs); Bugbot and Cursor Security clean; awaiting Codex review

WHAT WAS BUILT

- **A second synthetic domain, a salon** (`salon_ops/`): stylists, hourly openings, visits, customer-bound tokens, its own scopes, and rules the clinic lacks (service offered, 24 h late-cancel, 3 upcoming visits). Built first by **copying** the clinic's code. 18 golden tasks, 11 negative controls.
- `mcp_ops_kit/`, extracted from what the two copies shared: auth (scopes + subject as an `AuthConfig`), limits, a SQLite per-call deadline base, server wiring with a fail-closed start, the eval harness (`EvalDomain`), grader (`SubjectRule`), agents, runner, smoke test.
- **Both eval gates run on the kit in CI.** The salon shrank from 2,150 lines as a copy to 954; the clinic's tool schemas and live-agent prompt are byte-identical.

HOW IT WORKS

A domain writes	The kit does
AuthConfig: scopes, subject claim, ID pattern	Hashed tokens, CLI, scope and binding checks in code
register(server, guard): its tools	Rate limit before validation, health, /mcp + /healthz, serve
A SqliteStore subclass: schema, seed, rules	One deadline over lock wait, busy wait and query
EvalDomain + golden tasks + controls	Fresh data and real server per task, grading, report, gate

WHY IT WAS DONE THIS WAY

- **Copy, then extract.** Diffing each copy against its original gave the kit's whole interface: limits.py differed in 0 lines, the grader only in the subject, the harness in data, clock and IDs. Nothing is configurable that a second user did not need.
- **Clinic API kept, behaviour pinned** by the schema snapshot, the FHIR parity test (363 tests, identical trajectories) and a test that the kit never imports a domain.

WHAT WENT WRONG OR SURPRISED ME (LOGGED IN FAILURES.MD)

- **A fail-open token loader since Part 3.** Unknown keys were ignored, so a mistyped or foreign binding key loaded an *unbound* token (reproduced on the old code). The kit refuses unknown keys; a test fails if that is reverted.
- **My own draft leaked the clinic** into the kit (APT IDs as a default, a clinic-only report title), and one salon control was caught by the wrong check. Both fixed. Mutations: dropping the late-cancel rule or the visit limit fails the salon gate.

VERIFY IT YOURSELF

```
pytest -q                          # 286 passed
python -m evals.run                # clinic 31/31, 12/12
python -m salon_ops.evals.run      # salon 18/18, 11/11
```

INTERVIEW TALKING POINT

"I refused to design the library first. I built a second domain by copy-paste, diffed the copies, and extracted exactly the difference as configuration. The diff also showed a pre-existing fail-open in token loading."

NEXT (YOUR ACTIONS)

1) Paste the Codex prompt (STATUS.md). 2) Merge PR #18 once green. 3) Say **go** for Part 9.